

India's independence struggle.

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India's Independence Struggle: A Summary

Main Phases (1857-1947)

- **1857 Revolt:** Armed rebellion against British colonial rule
- **Early Nationalism (1885-1905):** Formation of Indian National Congress and constitutional activism
- **Swadeshi & Swaraj Movements (1905-1920s):** Emphasis on self-reliance and self-governance
- **Gandhian Era (1930-1947):** Nonviolent civil disobedience campaigns leading to independence on August 15, 1947

The movement evolved from armed resistance to constitutional nationalism to mass peaceful protest.

Impact of Satyagraha

Gandhi's nonviolent resistance fundamentally transformed the struggle by:

- Uniting diverse populations around peaceful principles
- Making British rule morally indefensible internationally
- Generating widespread sympathy and support
- Proving nonviolent methods could achieve political change
- Establishing a blueprint for future independence and civil rights movements globally

Key campaigns included the **Salt March (1930)** and mass boycotts that accelerated British withdrawal.

Key Political Leaders

- **Jawaharlal Nehru:** Congress leader and first Prime Minister; shaped India's secular, democratic vision
- **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel:** Unified princely states; served as Deputy Prime Minister
- **B.R. Ambedkar:** Chaired Constitution drafting committee; protected minority and Dalit rights

These leaders alongside Gandhi negotiated with Britain, mobilized movements, and established institutional foundations for independent India's democratic republic.